

This approach to PC security is very different from that of CleverCrypt—in the former, you place your documents in a specially created drive; here, you don’t create anything, just encrypt them wherever they are. WinGuard may be a better software for you if you want to restrict access on your PC to other things besides files. If files are all you want to protect from prying eyes, CleverCrypt is lighter and simpler, and may be a better choice.

7.6 Tips & Tricks

Anti-virus

1. Never, ever switch off the resident-protection feature of your anti-virus, even if it decreases the performance of your computer. If the performance decrease is unacceptable, upgrade!
2. Keep your virus definitions up-to-date. Use the auto-update feature of your anti-virus, and don’t ignore the “do you want to update now” messages, however often they seem to be popping up.
3. Even if your definitions are regularly updated and you haven’t noticed any suspicious activity on your computer, do a thorough system scan at least once a month.
4. Most people skip this step, and then suffer later: always create an emergency boot disk and keep it in a safe place!
5. In some cases, running an anti-virus scan in Safe Mode will allow you to find and kill viruses that would otherwise remain hidden.

Firewalls

6. If you are doing something that requires Net access, allowing the traffic would be necessary. If you are not expecting, or unsure of what is going on, using a search engine will give you an idea of what the program is. Say a.exe is attempting to connect to the Internet. A search on Google will give you an idea of what a.exe is.
7. If you’re new to firewalls and you’d like to know how vulnerable your computer is, head to [https://www.grc.com/x/ne.dll?bh0bkyd2/](https://www.grc.com/x/ne.dll?bh0bkyd2) and follow the instructions.
8. A firewall is a powerful tool that requires an understanding of how the program works and what exactly it is doing. Reading